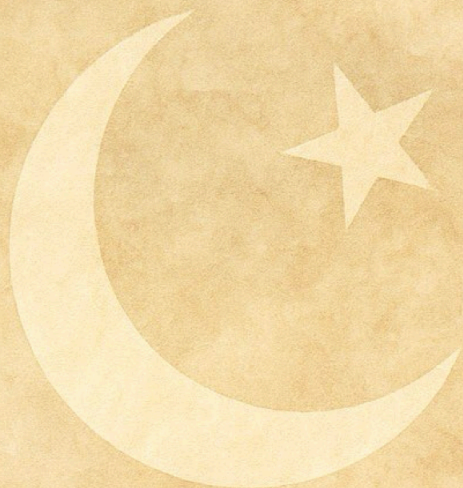


TRUE FREEDOM

*An Insight into the Concept of
Freedom from the **Divine Word***



by
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True *Freedom*

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***In the Name of Allah,
the All-beneficent,
the All-merciful.***

Introduction

In today's world, the term "freedom" is often interpreted as "doing whatever one desires," regardless of whether it leads to moral decay or social corruption.

However, the Holy Qur'an defines true freedom as liberation from ignorance, injustice, and the slavery of the self, and it guides humanity toward the light of divine truth.

The Holy Qur'an teaches through its timeless verses that true liberty lies in molding oneself according to the will of Allah—that is, choosing the path of righteousness with full consciousness and responsibility. An attempt has been made to present these concepts in

a simple and easily understandable manner so that we may understand these ideas and teachings ourselves and also acquaint our children with them.

May Allah continue to increase us all in knowledge and awareness.

Insha'Allah (God willing).

Wassalaam, (Peace)

Syed Imon Rizvi

August 2025

Dedication

To the Leader of the Prophets,
the Master of Both Worlds,

Hazrat Muhammad Mustafa (peace
be upon him and his progeny)

Who, through his blessed life
(Seerah),

taught us to encompass the
successes and triumphs of both
worlds with obedience and love for
Allah, the Exalted.

1. Human Dignity

The Foundation of Freedom

Allah has endowed every human being with innate dignity and purpose:

وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ وَحَمَلْنَاهُمْ فِي الْبَرِّ
وَالْبَحْرِ وَرَزَقْنَاهُمْ مِنَ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَفَضَّلْنَاهُمْ
عَلَى كَثِيرٍ مِمَّنْ خَلَقْنَا تَفْضِيلًا
(Al-Isra 17:70)

Translation:

“And We have certainly honored the Children of Adam and carried them on land and sea and provided for them of the good things and preferred them over much of what We have created, with [definite] preference.”

The beginning of freedom lies in acknowledging that you have been created for greatness—as Allah's vicegerent on earth—not for servitude to falsehood or oppression. This honor and dignity itself indicates how important a human being's status is in this world.

Therefore, a person must first understand their own existence so that by understanding themselves and their "self," they can become capable of traversing the next stages.

2. Liberation from Ignorance

The Qur'an is the light that frees the human mind from the darkness of ignorance and misguidance:

الرَّكِتَابُ أَنزَلْنَاهُ إِلَيْكَ لِتُخْرِجَ النَّاسَ مِنَ
الظُّلُمَاتِ إِلَى النُّورِ بِإِذْنِ رَبِّهِمْ إِلَى صِرَاطِ
الْعَزِيزِ الْحَمِيدِ

(Ibrahim 14:1)

Translation:

"Alif, Lam, Ra. [This is] a Book which We have revealed to you, [O Muhammad], that you might bring mankind out of darknesses into the light by permission of their Lord - to the path of the Exalted in Might, the Praiseworthy."

وَنَزَّلُ مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ مَا هُوَ شِفَاءٌ وَرَحْمَةٌ
لِّلْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَلَا يَزِيدُ الظَّالِمِينَ إِلَّا خَسَارًا

(Al-Isra 17:82)

Translation:

“And We send down of the Qur'an that which is healing and mercy for the believers, but it does not increase the wrongdoers except in loss.”

True freedom begins with knowledge, faith, and gratitude, which replaces false beliefs with the truth revealed by Allah.

Therefore, it is necessary to understand that if guidance is needed, then a guide is also needed, and the Qur'an itself states that it has been sent for our guidance.

And this Qur'an will provide both knowledge and guidance, and from it will come healing and mercy, on the condition of faith.

So, man was honored by God and was also given guidance to traverse further stages. Now, can man do anything on his own? Let's see.

3. Free Will and Responsibility

The Qur'an affirms that every individual is given free will. At the same time, the responsibility for their choice rests upon them:

وَأَنْ لَّيْسَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ إِلَّا مَا سَعَىٰ
(An-Najm 53:39)

Translation:

"And that there is not for man except that [good] for which he strives."

وَقُلِ الْحَقُّ مِنْ رَبِّكُمْ فَمَنْ شَاءَ فَلْيُؤْمِنْ وَمَنْ
شَاءَ فَلْيُكْفُرْ

(Al-Kahf 18:29)

Translation:

"And say, 'The truth is from your Lord, so whoever wills - let him

believe; and whoever wills - let him disbelieve.”

لِيُنْذِرَ مَنْ كَانَ حَيًّا

(Yasin 36:70)

Translation:

“That it may warn whoever is alive [of heart].”

From these verses, it is clear that man has been granted autonomy; he has been given the power to make his own decisions through the blessing of intellect. The more effort he puts in, the more reward he will receive. And it is also clear that guidance affects the one with a conscience, meaning one who, after knowledge comes to them, accepts the truth and reality and takes every step in life with caution.

Therefore, autonomy and freedom are not just a gift—they are a test, and it should be known that the consequences of all decisions manifest in this world as well as in the Hereafter.

4. Knowledge – The Path to Elevation

The Qur'an raises the rank of those who combine faith with knowledge:

قُلْ هَلْ يَسْتَوِي الَّذِينَ يَعْلَمُونَ وَالَّذِينَ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ

(Az-Zumar 39:9)

Translation:

“Say, ‘Are those who know equal to those who do not know?’”

يَرْفَعُ اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا مِنْكُمْ وَالَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْعِلْمَ دَرَجَاتٍ

(Al-Mujadila 58:11)

Translation:

“Allah will raise those who have believed among you and those who were given knowledge, by degrees.”

Ignorance enslaves, but knowledge—when based on divine truth—bestows upon a person high and lofty ranks and makes them truly free.

In reality, in this era, freedom has lost its true definition and understanding, and our focus should be on understanding what freedom truly is in the sight of God.

5. The Life-Giving Call of Allah

Responding to Allah's guidance is described as being equivalent to giving life to the believer:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اسْتَجِيبُوا لِلَّهِ وَلِلرَّسُولِ
إِذَا دَعَاكُمْ لِمَا يُحْيِيكُمْ
(Al-Anfal 8:24)

Translation:

“O you who have believed, respond to Allah and to the Messenger when he calls you to that which gives you life.”

This “life” is more than mere physical existence—it is a state of spiritual vitality, moral strength, and inner peace. We know that our material body is made from dust, and after we die, it returns to dust

and is finished. But the thing that holds life is the soul (Ruh), and that soul is granted life only when a person moves toward Allah and His Messenger. Whenever these two call a person, the meaning is simply that they are being called toward attaining life; this is true freedom.

6. The Promise of a Pure Life

For those who live a life of righteousness, Allah promises a most excellent life here and eternal happiness in the Hereafter:

مَنْ عَمِلَ صَالِحًا مِنْ ذَكَرٍ أَوْ أُنْثَىٰ وَهُوَ
مُؤْمِنٌ فَلَنُحْيِيَنَّهٗ حَيَاةً طَيِّبَةً وَلَنَجْزِيَنَّهُمْ
أَجْرَهُمْ بِأَحْسَنِ مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ

(An-Nahl 16:97)

Translation:

“Whoever does righteousness, whether male or female, while he is a believer - We will surely cause him to live a good life, and We will surely give them their reward [in the Hereafter] according to the best of what they used to do.”

وَمَا هَذِهِ الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا إِلَّا لَهُوٌّ وَلَعِبٌ وَإِنَّ
الدَّارَ الْآخِرَةَ لَهِيَ الْحَيَوَانُ لَوْ كَانُوا يَعْلَمُونَ

(Al-Ankabut 29:64)

Translation:

“And this worldly life is not but diversion and amusement. And indeed, the home of the Hereafter - that is the [actual] life, if only they knew.”

True freedom is the name of living with the awareness that this world is temporary, and true success lies in the eternal life of the Hereafter.

Conclusion

The Qur'an makes it clear that freedom is not the name of lawlessness, and it is also necessary to understand that performing futile and worthless acts in the name of celebrating freedom is also not freedom. Rather, freedom is to live with a divine purpose, in the guidance of truth, and free from the chains of ignorance, oppression, and carnal desires.

Its beginning comes from dignity, it is nurtured through knowledge, and it reaches its perfection in obedience to Allah.

When we embrace Quranic freedom, we attain true freedom

not just physically, but also in
heart, mind, and soul.

Quranic References

Surah al-Isra 17:70

Surah Ibrahim 14:1

Surah al-Isra 17:82

Surah an-Najm 53:39

Surah al-Kahf 18:29

Surah Yasin 36:70

Surah az-Zumar 39:9

Surah al-Mujadila 58:11

Surah al-Anfal 8:24

Surah an-Nahl 16:97

Surah al-Ankabut 29:64